Word clock setup

A short guide for the finished clock. You do not need to install any software. The full builder notes are in README.md. Firmware **0.8.64**.



*The face above is reading **twenty past eleven**. Minute words are red, PAST is warm, and the hour is purple.*

The clock uses a 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi network. A 5 GHz-only network will not appear in its list.

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1. Plug it in

Use the USB cable and a normal USB charger. The middle of the face takes one quiet breath, then the hour words count **ONE**, **TWO**, **THREE** until the clock has the time.

From 11:45 pm to 7:00 am the face is dark on purpose. That blackout is already turned on. Change the hours on the **Night** tab once the page is open.

2. Join the clock's own Wi-Fi

On a new clock, or after the home network has been missing for about 10 minutes, the clock opens its own network.

1. On your phone, open Wi-Fi and choose the network named **wordclock8x8-** followed by six letters or numbers. An example is `wordclock8x8-fbe009`. Every clock has its own ending. There is no password.
2. If the phone asks you to sign in to the network, allow it. Otherwise open a browser and go to **http://192.168.4.1**
3. Pick your home Wi-Fi, enter its password, and save.

The clock then leaves that setup network and joins your home network. Put your phone back on the home Wi-Fi as well.

If the clock has a button, holding it for about 6 seconds opens this setup network again. You can also unplug the clock and plug it back in **three times**, without leaving it running for 3 minutes in

between. The face spells **AP** and the setup network comes back.

3. Open the clock

When the home network connects, the face spells the **last part of its address** for 5 seconds.

Address ending	What the face spells
`.74`	SEVEN in red, FOUR in green
`.123`	ONE in red, TWO in green, THREE in blue
a `0` in the number	the letter **O**

The setup page also shows the full address. Either of these opens the clock:

- `http://wordclock8x8.local` — when this is the only word clock on the network
- `http://wordclock8x8-fbe009.local` — when another clock is already awake. Use the same ending as the setup network name
- `http://192.168.0.74` — use the address the page showed, with your own numbers

The top of the page is a live copy of the face. Under the date you will see this clock's address, then **Other word clocks** if another clock on the same network is awake. A clock that has turned its radio off for the night does not appear in that list.

4. Set your time zone

A new clock starts on **Atlantic Time**. On the **Time** tab, choose your zone and save. The words on the face follow that zone.

The clock gets the time from the internet about once an hour. After the first successful set, it keeps that time through a power cut and a Wi-Fi outage. If the hour words keep counting **ONE**, **TWO**, **THREE**, the clock does not have a time yet. Check the Wi-Fi password, or set the time by hand on the **Time** tab.

5. How to read the face

The plate in the photo is the **EN 8×8** face. It shows the time in five-minute steps:

- on the hour, only the hour (**THREE**, **ELEVEN**, …)
- **FIVE**, **TEN**, **FIFTEEN**, **TWENTY**, or **TWENTY FIVE** past or to the hour
- **HALF PAST** for 30 minutes

Fifteen minutes is the word **FIFTEEN**, not QUARTER. With the extra-minute dots left off, 11:23 still reads as twenty past eleven. Turn the dots on from the **Look** tab to show the extra one to four minutes.

6. Colours, brightness, and night

Open the page and use the tabs:

Tab	What you change
Look	Colour, brightness, the seconds tick, and how the words change
Night	Dimmer hours, the blackout window, and a daily alarm
Face	Leave this on **EN 8×8 TWFIFTHA** unless you built a different letter plate
About	Firmware version, a settings backup, and updates

Reading shades is the look in the photo: minute words red, PAST or TO warm brown, the hour purple. **Reset all colors** on the Look tab returns to that.

While the clock is saving a change, the time words go dark and the face spells **SAVING**. The first letter is red, the second green, the third blue, and any letters after that are white. The same colours are used for **WIFI**, **NIGHT**, **SLEEP**, and **UPDATING**.

7. Updates

Leave the clock powered overnight. Once a day, at **3:00 am** local time, it checks for a newer version and installs it. The face spells **UPDATING** while that happens. Leave it plugged in until the time comes back.

You can turn that check off, or pick another time, on the **About** tab under **Check GitHub every day at**.

8. A new router or a new house

The clock keeps trying the saved network. After about 10 minutes without it, the setup network from step 2 comes back. Join `wordclock8x8–……`, open **http://192.168.4.1**, and enter the new Wi-Fi.

The setup network name stays tied to the clock even if you rename the page. Typing `wordclock8x8` on the dashboard returns the page to the automatic name: `wordclock8x8.local` when this clock is alone, and the MAC name when another clock is awake.

9. If it does not look right

What you see	What to do
Face is dark in the evening or early morning	Blackout is on from 11:45 pm to 7:00 am. Change it on the **Night** tab.
WIFI, then the old time	The home network was not found. The clock shows the saved time after about 20 seconds and keeps trying.
Hour words counting ONE, TWO, THREE	No time yet. Confirm Wi-Fi on the **Time** tab, or set the clock by hand.
Time is off by hours	The zone is still Atlantic Time. Choose yours on the **Time** tab.
Words lit in the wrong places	On the **Align** tab, match the lit corners to the printed letters.
The page will not open	Rejoin the home Wi-Fi, then try the `.local` name and the number address.

Wiring, flashing, and the serial menu are in README.md.
